

The Junior Money Climb

Ages 6–12 · family night · 30 minutes · one screen, the free game, this page

For your homeschool table — a 30-minute lesson, zero prep. Open the free game on any screen and follow the five steps. Where a step says “the room/the group,” read it as your family; where it says “host,” that’s you.

1 · THE HOOK (3 min)

Hold up a dollar (or draw one): “What is this, actually? Why will a stranger hand you a candy bar for paper?”

2 · PLAY TOGETHER (12 min)

The youngest reads each question aloud (with help); the family votes by show of hands; parents vote LAST and must explain their vote in one sentence.

Play together: the group votes before anyone clicks, and every explanation is read aloud — the explanation is the lesson.

3 · THE TALK (8 min)

1. What’s the difference between a need and a want — and is candy ever a need? (Let them argue!)
2. Why save for something instead of buying a smaller thing today?
3. If you ran a lemonade stand, what would the lemons cost — and what is profit?

4 · SOLO CLIMB (5 min)

Each child answers three questions solo for “banker’s badges” (parent-invented, sticker-grade).

5 · THE TAKEAWAY (2 min)

“Saving is buying something bigger later.”

Homework: Every child picks one savings goal and posts a drawing of it on the refrigerator.

THE TEACHING CREED

You are not the expert; the game is. Your job is to vote last, read aloud well, and ask “why?” one more time than feels natural. Celebrate wrong answers loudly — in here, wrong is where the lesson lives.

GENO — the GSU tutor you can talk to, free, 24/7 in 32 languages — can explain any answer a second way.